

Business Impact Awards



Unlocking Unprecedented
\$8.7MM Revenue Growth For
UnitedHealthcare By Way Of Key
Night Market X Horizon Next
Partnership

Unlocking \$8.75MM Revenue Growth For DeVry University By Way Of Key Horizon Commerce X Horizon Next Partnership

Goals/Challenge This Case Solves:

DeVry University, a leading online higher-education provider, had been managing their own paid search account in-house — with diminishing returns on a high-spend program. Cost per inquiry was climbing, Visit-to-Inquiry (V2I) rates were stagnating, and a growing share of high-spend keywords were routing users to landing pages that were not the best semantic match for their query. As enrollment competition in the online education space intensified, DeVry needed an agency partner who could rapidly diagnose, prescribe, and execute a sweeping account overhaul without sacrificing in-market performance.

Horizon Next was brought in to take ownership of the paid search account and steer it back to growth via sweeping account updates. Horizon Commerce was activated as a strategic CRO partner, tasked with measurably testing the impact of re-mapping landing pages to better match query intent, with light landing-page UX optimization layered in as additive lift. The main objective: drive incremental qualified inquiries and applications at a lower cost.

Insights:

1. Query-to-Landing-Page Misalignment as a Hidden Lever: Joint discovery between Horizon Next's paid search team and Horizon Commerce's CRO team surfaced that a substantial share of high-spend keywords were routing users to landing pages that were not the best semantic match for the query, depressing V2I rates across the highest-volume program areas (Business, Tech, Health). Re-mapping those queries was a zero-design-cost lever with material revenue upside.

2. On-Page UX Could Be Optimized in Parallel — Not Sequentially: A heuristic UX audit of DeVry's highest-traffic landing pages revealed several form trust-signal weaknesses. These created opportunities for additive A/B tests (e.g., pre-filling the Area of Study dropdown by page intent) that could be layered on top of the redirect work, compounding gains without disrupting the page restructure roadmap.

3. Test-Cell Methodology Could De-Risk Sweeping Account Changes: By packaging the redirects as measurable test cells — each with seasonal adjustment, confounding-variable controls, and statistical significance scoring — Next and Commerce gave the DeVry team confidence to greenlight account changes that would have otherwise been deferred. This established a 'test-and-roll' rhythm that materially accelerated the rate of in-market improvements.

How Strategic Approach Came to Life:

Horizon Next and Horizon Commerce designed a joint, integrated workflow centered on a five-step query-to-landing-page mapping process, combining paid search account expertise with CRO testing rigor. The two teams operated as a single unit through twice-weekly syncs, co-built roadmaps, and shared readouts that gave DeVry one consolidated point of view across the media-to-site funnel.

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How Strategic Approach Came to Life (Cont).:

The 5-Step Query-to-Landing-Page Mapping Process:

01 Group Identify mutually-exclusive lists of semantic keywords receiving bids, grouped by DeVry's program topics.	02 Map Map grouped keywords to best-fit landing pages and reference against the active LP serving those keywords today.	03 Diagnose For ill-mapped keywords, evaluate performance on the best-fit LP vs. other LPs still receiving traffic from those terms.	04 Test Where the best-fit LP outperforms, re-map the keyword to its best-fit page directly in the search platform.	05 Measure Evaluate post-redirect performance with PoP comparison, seasonal adjustment, and confounding-variable controls.
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PARALLEL TRACKS: ON-PAGE UX TESTING

Horizon Commerce ran a heuristic UX audit alongside the redirect work

Heuristic Audit Reviewed top-traffic LPs against CX & UX frameworks to surface dropdown, form-field, and trust-signal weaknesses.	Pre-Fill A/B Test (Win) Pre-filled the Area of Study dropdown on the Accounting LP — won at +17.11% V2I (statistically significant).	Additive, Not Disruptive UX tests layered on top of redirect work — compounding gains without slowing the page restructure roadmap.
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Tactical Execution:

- **Joint Discovery & Taxonomy Build:** Cross-team alignment between Next and Commerce to align on program taxonomy, semantic keyword grouping, and complete landing page inventory.
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- **Seasonal Adjustment Methodology:** Applied portfolio-level seasonal adjustment to isolate true redirect impact from organic seasonal variance in inquiry volume.
- **Confounding Variable Controls:** Documented and adjusted for parallel account changes (bid changes, copy iterations, audience shifts) inside each test window.
- **Heuristic UX Audit Layered In:** Reviewed top 20 highest-traffic landing pages against Baymard / NNG / CXL frameworks to surface highest-impact additive UX test ideas.
- **Pre-Fill A/B Test (Accounting LP):** Launched a pre-fill test on the Area of Study dropdown for the Accounting LP — won at +17.11% V2I, statistically significant, ~\$732K net revenue impact alone.
- **Readouts to DeVry:** Established a recurring cadence with the DeVry team to share results, surface implications, and reprioritize the joint roadmap in real time.
- **Roll-Forward Playbook:** Winning redirects rolled to permanent destinations in the search platform; losing cells documented and added back to roadmap with revised hypotheses.

Results:

\$8.75MM 12-Month Est. Revenue Impact	1,483 12-Month Est. Incremental Apps	7,808 12-Month Est. Incremental Inquiries	267K Visits Impacted	47x Initial ROI on HC Agency Fee	+17.11% V2I Lift on Pre-Fill UX Test
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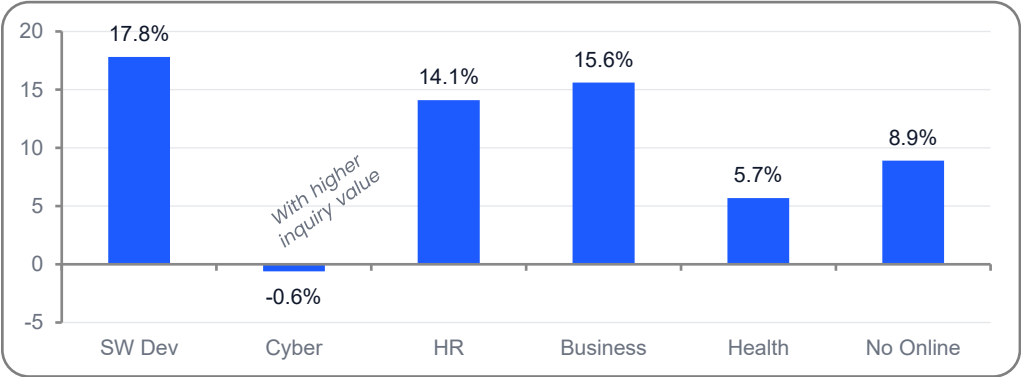
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Results (cont.)

6-Cell Paid Search Redirect Test — Adjusted Results

Test Cell	V2I Lift (Adj)	Incr. Inq.	Significance
Software Development	+17.8%	+36	Stat Sig
Cybersecurity	-0.6%	-17	Not Sig
Human Resources	+14.1%	+141	Stat Sig
Business / Project Mgmt	+15.6%	+274	Stat Sig
Broad Health	+5.7%	+23	Not Sig
No Online Options	+8.9%	+295	Stat Sig
TOTAL (Adjusted)	+8.3%	+752	Stat Sig

Adjusted V2I Lift by Re-Map Test Cell (%)



Test-period results (8.3% adjusted V2I lift = +752 incremental inquiries) extrapolate to ~\$8.07MM in incremental revenue over a 12-month period when applied against L12M paid search traffic.

Pre-Fill UX Test

Hypothesis

Pre-filling the Area of Study field by page intent (Accounting & Finance on the Accounting LP) would reduce form friction and increase Visit-to-Inquiry rate.

Result

+17.11% V2I lift (Stat Sig) • **+\$678K** net revenue impact annualized

12-MONTH PROJECTED IMPACT (PROGRAM TO DATE → ROLLED FORWARD)

\$732K Revenue impact realized so far	\$8.75MM 12-Month projected revenue impact	849 / 7,808 Inquiries: realized / 12-mo projected	123 / 1,483 Apps: realized / 12-mo projected	10 Tests completed
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Next Steps

01 Specialized Intent-to-LP Mapping

Enable specialized-intent query routing to program-specific landing pages via paid search account re-structure and on-site tracking enhancements. Phase 1 proved the lift at the topic level; Phase 2 extends the same discipline down into specializations, where the highest-intent queries come from.

BROAD LP



/get-started/business/accounting

SPECIALIZATION LP



/business/accounting (Bachelor's)

02 Progressive Journey Testing

For broader queries where 1:1 program matches don't exist, test progressive journeys that pull users from broad LPs onto specific topics and specializations via on-page decision gates. Precedent in market (ASU, University of Phoenix, Colorado State, Walden) and data from Phase 1 showing specific queries convert 44% better on specific LPs both support the hypothesis that progressive specificity will engage upper-funnel researchers without forcing a premature mapping decision.

Content Progression Engages Researching Users

